Team Guide for Group Discussions

Day 1

What on Earth Am I Here for?

It All Starts with God

- It is not about you.
- You were made by God and for God. It is only in God that we discover our origin, our identity, our meaning, our purpose, our significance, and our destiny.
- Life is about letting God use you for his purposes, not you using us for your own purpose.
- Being successful and fulfilling your life's purpose are not at all the same issue.
- The Bible gives us insights into our purpose:
  - You discover your identity and purpose through a relationship with Jesus.
  - God was thinking of you long before you ever thought about Him.
  - The purpose of your life fits into a much larger, cosmic purpose that God has designated for eternity.

❖ Questions to Consider ❖

In spite of all the surrounding advertising, how can I remind myself that life is really about living for God, not myself?

Day 2

You Are Not an Accident

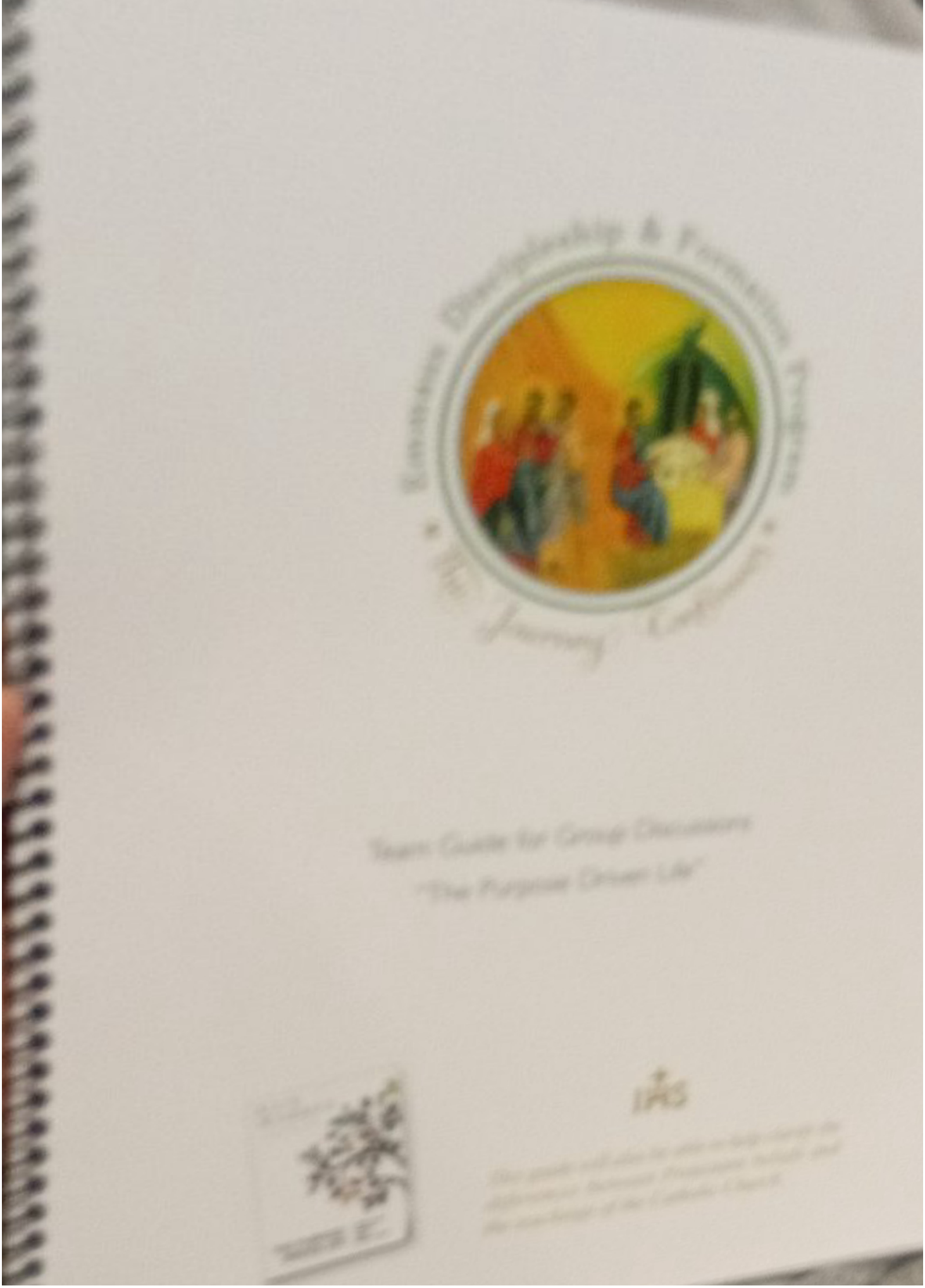
- Your birth was no mistake or mishap, and your life is no fluke of nature. Your parents may not have planned you, but God did.
- He also determined the natural talents you would possess and the uniqueness of your personality.
- He planned the days of your life in advance.

FYI: *We as Catholics do NOT believe in predestination because of our free will. He knows what we will do but does NOT control what we will do. God lets things happen because of free will, but afterwards, He is there to bring good out of bad, light out of darkness.*

- You were created as a special object of God's love! God made you so He could love you.
- The Bible tells us, "God is love." Love is the essence of God's character.

❖ Questions to Consider ❖

I know that God uniquely created me. What areas of my personality, background, and physical appearance am I struggling to accept?


Team Guide for Group Discussions
"The Purpose Driven Life"

Day 3

What drives your life?

- Here are *five* of the most common values & emotions that drive your life:
  1. Guilt
     - God specializes in giving people a fresh start
     - *The Sacrament of Reconciliation/Confessions/Penance: We are products but not prisoners of the past.*
  2. *Resentment and anger*
  3. *Fear*
  4. *Materialism*
  5. *Need for approval*
- Here are *five* benefits of living a purpose-driven life:
  1. *Gives meaning to your life*
  2. *Simplifies your life*
  3. *Focuses your life*
  4. *Motivates your life*
     - *Prepares you for eternity*
     - *The Catholic Church teaches about less attachment to the here and now, with more focus on eternity.*
  5. *focus on eternity.*
- From the Bible we can surmise that God will ask us two crucial questions:
  - What did you do with my son, Jesus Christ?
  - What did you do with the gifts, talents, opportunities, energy, relationships, and resources God gave you?

Questions to consider

What would my family and friends say is the driving force, force of my life? What do I want it to be?

Day 4

Made to Last Forever

- Life on Earth is just the dress rehearsal before the real production.
- While life on earth offers many choices, eternity offers only two: heaven or hell. Your relationship to God on Earth will determine your relationship to Him in eternity.
- In heaven we will be reunited with loved ones who are believers.
  - *Catholic teachings hold the door to heaven is open for all those who faithfully follow the lights with which God has illuminated their hearts. He who seeks the truths and does the will of God in accordance with his understanding of it can be saved.*
- If you have a relationship with God through Jesus, you don't need to fear death.
- Death will be your birthday into eternal life.
- It would be wiser to live each day as if it were the last day of your life.

Points to Ponder

Since I was made to last forever, what is the one thing I should stop doing and the one thing I should start doing today?